

Introduction to the Unit

In Grade VI, you studied history of South Asia. In Grade VII, the history of Asia is being shared with you. During the middle ages, Asia had become home to some of the most advanced civilizations on the Earth. The following chapters on history take you to the journey of the great civilizations of Asia and will acquaint you with the ancient times when the Mauryans came to India and established their Empire. Later, we discuss the Mauryan and Persian Empires. Lastly, the main events of medieval period and their associated elements are discussed.

CHAPTER :1**THE ANCIENT WORLD: INDIA****SLOs:**

- Name the empires that existed in the world between 500 BCE and 500 CE.
- Construct a timeline showing the different dynasties of India from 500 BCE to 500 CE.
- Describe the rise of the Mauryan Empire.
- Explain the causes of the emergence of Buddhism in India.
- Analyze the effect of the religious policy of Ashoka (promotion of Buddhism) on the region.
- Describe the role of Ashoka in the development of Mauryan power and prestige.
- Describe how trade routes expanded during the Mauryan age.
- Describe the social life of the people during the Mauryan rule.
- Identify the contributing factors that brought about the rapid decline to The Mauryan Empire.
- Identify key events and personalities in the Mauryan Empire.
- Identify the defining characteristics of the Gupta Empire.
- Describe the cultural, scientific and mathematical advancements made at the time of the Gupta Empire.
- Trace Alexander's expedition in North West India.
- Locate on a map of the world the land and sea routes through which trade and social contacts were established between India and the rest of the world.

Introduction

This chapter mainly focuses on rise and fall of the Mauryan Empire. You will be able to learn about the emergence of Buddhism. Furthermore, you will also study about the King Ashoka and his policies. The Gupta Empire and invasions of Alexander the Great are also discussed in this chapter.

The Mauryan Empire

Chandragupta Maurya was born as the first ruler of the Mauryan Empire. The Southern part of the kingdom was located on the Ganges River. It was ruled by the Nanda Family. Chandragupta killed the Nanda king. In this way, he expanded Mauryan Empire.

Chandragupta further expanded the empire by conquering small kingdoms of India.

Chandragupta was succeeded by his son Bindusara (reigned 298-272 BC). He continued his father's policy of expansion by extending Mauryan power down into central India. Bindusara was followed by his son Ashoka (reigned 272-232 BC). Ashoka proved to be one of the most remarkable and attractive rulers in the history of India, and indeed the whole of world history.

Do You Know?

This is a common belief that Chandra Gupta belonged to Pea cock tamers. Thus, the empire is called Mauryan Empire

Chandragupta



Bindusara



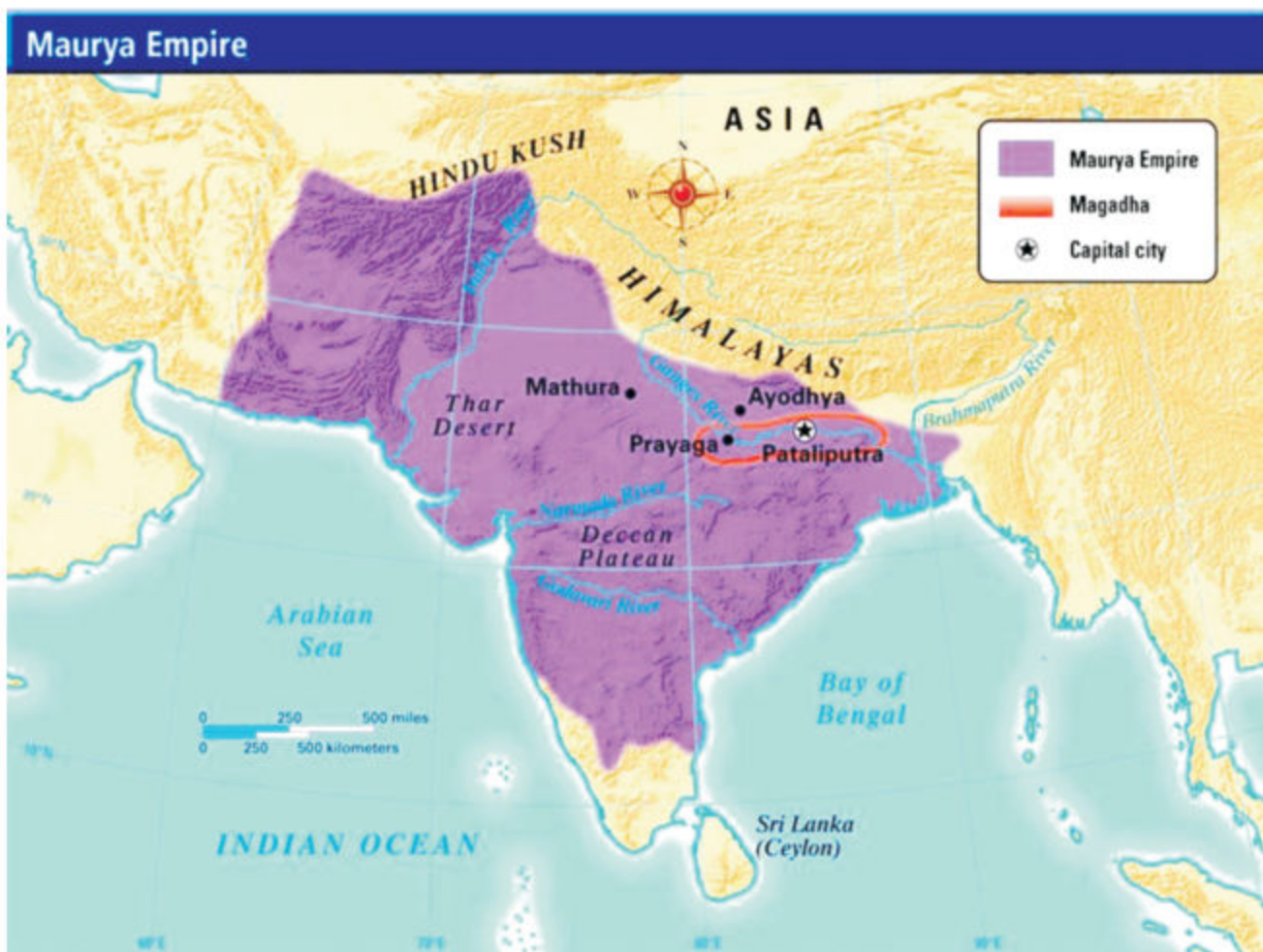
Ashoka



Chandragupta Maurya The Greatest Ruler in the Indian History

Activity

- Look at the online encyclopedia and name the empires that existed in the world between 500 BCE and 500 CE.
- Using the encyclopedia, construct a timeline showing the different dynasties of India from 500 BCE to 500 CE.



Map of the Mauryan Empire

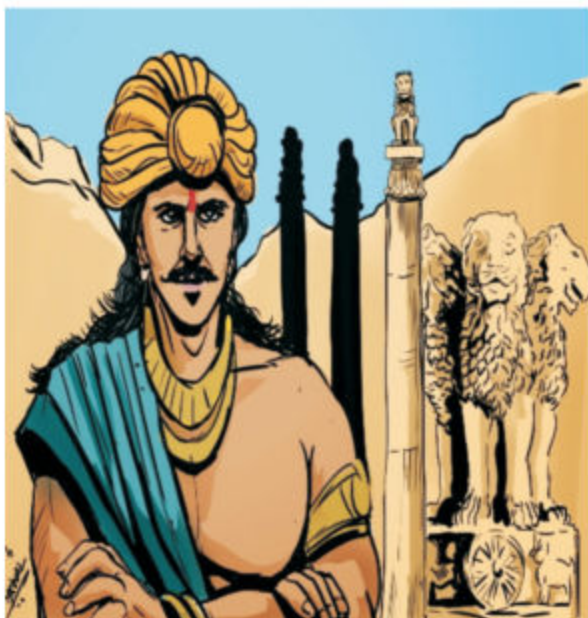
Source: www.timemaps.com

The map shown above is of the Mauryan Empire in 265 BCE. By the end of the empire's existence, much of India was its part. The Southern tip of the peninsula and the right part of the continent weren't completely part of the dynasty, but they were not complete rivals of the empire. Not all of the expansion was done by Chandragupta, but there were also contributions made by other rulers including Bindusara and Ashoka.

Activity

Work together in pairs and look at the map to locate the land and sea routes through which trade and social contacts were established between India and the rest of the world during this period.

King Ashoka



Ashoka

Ashoka's Welfare Work

- He built roads and many wells for the people.
- He built rest houses for travelers.
- He promoted plantation and planted a number of trees along the sides of roads.
- He arranged for medical treatments of both humans and animals.
- He was the first Empire builder of ancient India.
- He gave the world Dhamma (moral code of conduct) by imbibing the best teaching of all religions present at that time.

Chandrapta's grandson Ashoka proved to be one of the most remarkable rulers in the history of India, and indeed the whole of world history. After a bloody war against Kalinga in Eastern India, Ashoka renounced warfare and converted to Buddhism. He determined that he would reign in peace. He actively promoted the spread of Buddhism and sent missions abroad to Sri Lanka and South East Asia. He also sent missions to the Greek-speaking kingdoms to the West, which had carved up Alexander the Great's conquests between them.

Government and Rulers

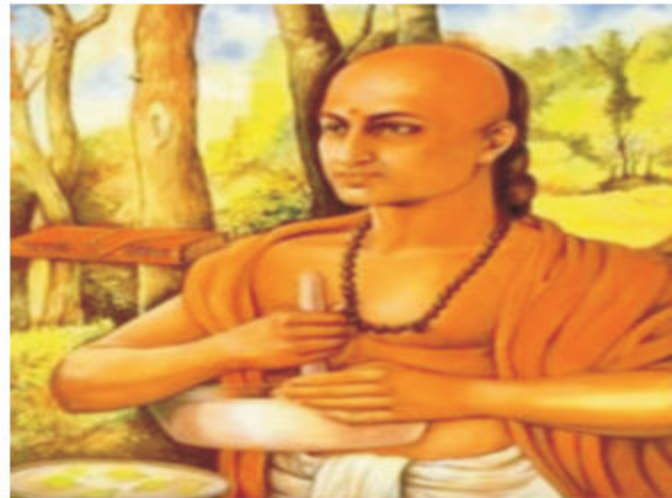
Chandragupta was a pioneer of administration in India. Chandragupta relied much on his main adviser, Kautilya who wrote the Arthashastra which was a book of rules to run the Empire. Chandragupta also created a bureaucratic government consisting of many people having various jobs that he would supervise. To keep rule under his control, he divided the empire into four provinces, each with their own royal prince. Provinces were further divided into local districts which were administered on the basis of rules enshrined in the Arthashastra book.

The other two rulers of the Mauryan Empire were Bindusara and Ashoka. Both of these rulers were decedents of Chandragupta, Bindusara being his son and Ashoka being his grandson. While Ashoka was in rule,

the empire was at its hieght. As soon as Ashoka died, the country went out of control and resulted in the fall of the Mauryan Empire.



Chandragupta Maurya



Bindusara

Religion

Ashoka became Emperor in 269 BC and he followed a Hindu King Chandragupta's footsteps. In the beginning, he expanded his Empire through warfare which caused killing of thousands of innocent people. Later, he realized that bloodshed was not necessary for expansion. Eventually, he began to study Buddhism and concluded that his Empire was going to follow the teachings of peace and harmony to all beings and nirvana. Practicing this non-violent and peaceful religion throughout the empire, brought many people under the rule without use of violence. This helped the Mauryan Empire to grow and to reach to the height that it reached as an empire.



Religious temple during Ashoka's time



**Indian relief from Amaravati, Guntur.
Preserved in Guimet Museum**

Culture and Society

The Mauryan society comprised of seven casts namely, philosophers, Farmers, Soldiers, Herdsmen, Artisans, Magistrates and Councilors. Chaturvarna system continued to govern the society. The urban way of life developed and the craftsmen enjoyed a high place in the society. Teaching continued to be the main job of the Brahmans. Buddhist monasteries were developed as important educational institutions. Taxila, Ujjayini and Varanasi were famous educational centers. Technical education was generally provided through guilds, where pupils learnt the crafts from the early age. The joint family system was the norm in the domestic life. A married woman had her own property in the form of bride-gift (stree-dhana). The widows had given respect in the society. All stree-dhana (bride-gift and jewelry) belongs to her. Offences against women were severely dealt with.

Economy and Society

The Mauryan period, particularly during the reign of Ashoka, experienced an extensive period of peace. Peace encouraged prosperity and the government actively promoted agriculture and trade. Trade routes created were secured which made long distance commerce and trading easier. The archaeological record suggests that the standard of living rose during Mauryan rule. Iron tools were widely used and helped the reclamation of land for farming, and led to greater productivity for farmers. Metal coinage became more widespread and promoted trade. Palitpura, the Mauryan capital was a large and impressive city. In addition, religious values were promoted through the process of inscribing on rocks.



Silver punch mark coin of the Maurya Empire, with symbols of wheel and elephant.

Decline of the Mauryan Empire

The death of Ashoka was the beginning of the end of the Mauryan Empire. Independent states that were loosely part of the Empire split and established their independent rule. The main empire that arose from the downfall of the Mauryan Empire was the Andhra Dynasty. The reason that they succeeded among the others was because of its geo-strategic position, which helped it to develop its trade links with Rome and South East Asia.

The Gupta Empire

For about five centuries after the fall of the Mauryan Empire, the Indian people remained under the rule of small city states. Then, a new leader emerged "Chandragupta II" who began to unite India again. Chandragupta II set up his capital in the old kingdom of Magadha. Under the rule of Chandragupta II and his decedents, the Gupta Empire flourished. This period is known as the golden period of history as great advances in art and science were made.

Under the rule of Gupta kings, the people returned to their Hindu roots and Hinduism became the religion of the state. Gupta kings lowered the taxes and encouraged freedom and personal development. As a result, the Gupta Empire became the center of arts, learning, science and technology, astronomy and maths for the region. After the death of Chandragupta II, the Gupta Empire began to fall apart. Later on, the succeeding rulers were not as effective in ruling the government as their predecessors were. As a result, the government became weaker and the Empire was destroyed by the invaders.

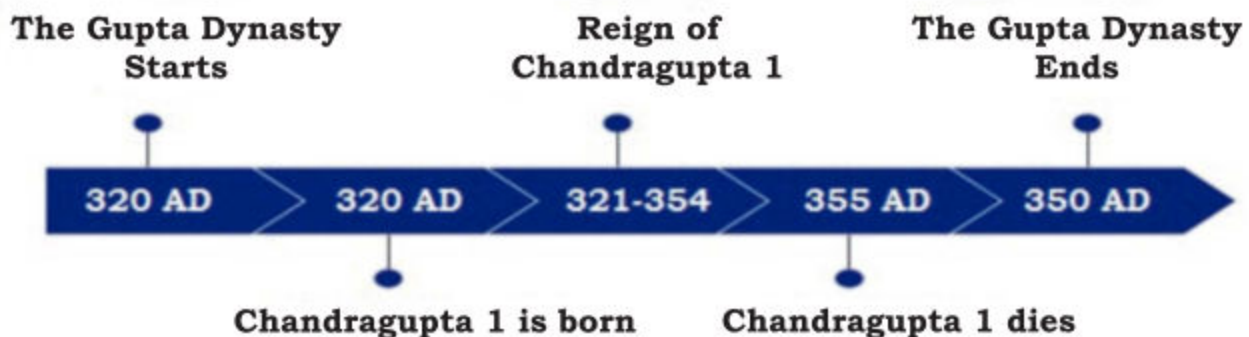


Map of Gupta Empire

Source: www.google.com.pk

Activity

Just the way you have studied about the Mauryan Empire, search on the internet or encyclopedia with your friends and find the information on The Gupta Empire. Find the information, prepare a poster presentation and share with your class. You may take help from the timeline shared below:



This timeline shows approximate years.

This timeline shows content related to Chandragupta 1.

Thus, it can be said that the ancient world started from 500 BCE to 500 CE. It observed many rulers and dynasties of which the most famous are the Mauryans and Guptas in Asia. The Mauryan Empire was known for its administrative skills and the rule of Ashok the great. The world has rarely seen such a skilled administrator and warrior. Following Ashok the great, India experienced the rule of the Guptas. The last skilled leader from the Gupta Empire was Chandragupta II. After his demise, there was no one to take care of the land and India experienced attacks of foreign warriors and invaders including Alexander the great.

SUMMARY

In this chapter, you studied about the ancient history from 500 BCE to 500 CE, the rise and fall of the Mauryan Empire, leadership of Ashoka and his administrative skills and the rise and fall of the Gupta Empire.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

Check Your Knowledge And Understanding

Fill in the blanks

- i. Chandragupta Maurya founded the Mauryan Empire in _____ BCE.
- ii. Chandragupta Maurya's grandson was _____.
- iii. The Mauryan Empire lasted about _____ years.
- iv. Ashoka became king at around _____ BC.
- v. Ashoka's Empire included much of _____ India.

Answer the following questions

Search in the encyclopedia or on the internet and answer the following:

- I. List the social, political, economic and administrative factors that influenced the development of the Mauryan Empire.

Column A: Factors	Column B: Impacts on the development of Mauryan Empire
Social	
Political	
Economic	
Administrative	

- II. While using a map, trace Alexander's expedition in North West India.
- III. Identify key events and personalities in the Mauryan Empire.
- IV. Identify the defining characteristics of the Gupta Empire.
- V. Describe the cultural, scientific and mathematical advancements made at the time of the Gupta Empire.

Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

Choose another empire of the same timeline of 500 BCE to 500 CE in any other location for your inquiry. Identify what was the culture, government, religion, architecture, technological innovations, geographical features and writings of that civilization. Prepare a presentation and share with your class.

Cooperate With Others

Working together in groups of four to six students, collect information on the Mauryan Empire and Gupta Empire and share the lessons learnt from the historical events associated with these two Empires.

Teacher's Note

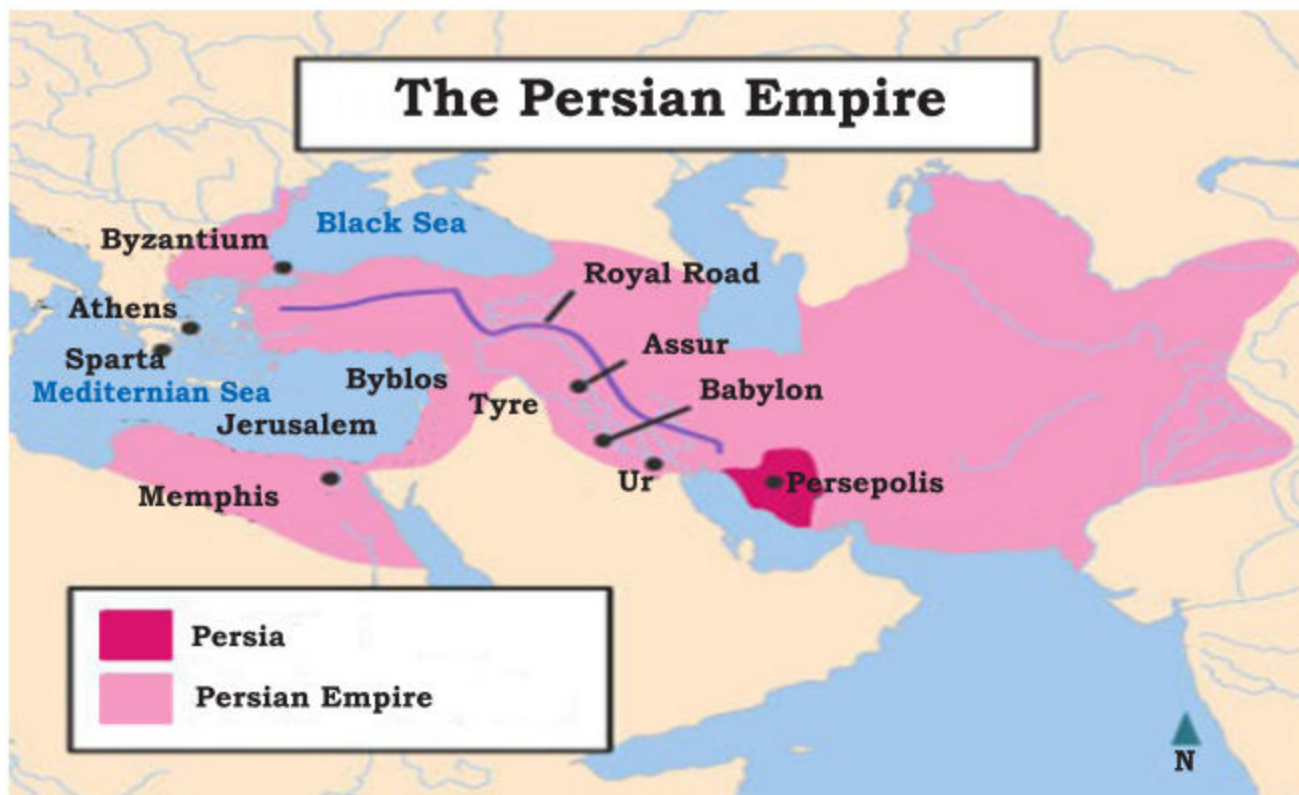
Encourage students to participate in class discussions and work on the given activities and tasks within the class under your supervision. Encourage use of encyclopedia, internet and newspaper. Try to use newspaper in your all classes and try to pick information from there. If the school has resources, the movie on Asoka can also be shown to students to understand the Mauryan civilization.

SLOs:

- On a world map, show the Persian Empire at the time of King Darius the Great (522-485 BCE).
- Describe the achievements of King Darius.
- Identify the territories that were part of the Persian Empire in 500 CE.
- Explain why the Persian Empire was regarded as the largest empire in the ancient world in 500 CE.
- Describe the Impact of the Zoroastrian religion on Persian society.
- Explain the reasons for the Persian Wars.
- List the battles fought between the Persians and the Greeks from 490 to 479 BCE and identify who won the battles.
- State reasons for the rise and fall of Persian Empire
- Describe the achievements of ancient India and Persia
- Describe the influence of the Persian Empire on social, political, cultural and religious life of the people.
- Illustrate on a map the expansion of the Persian Empire.
- Describe how the Persian Empire fared after the death of Alexander the Great.
- Describe how the Parthia Empire was affected by the Greek civilization.
- Describe and illustrate on a map how the Persian Empire remained divided amongst the Roman and Parthian empires.
- Inquire about another civilization (eg. Egyptian, Roman, Greek, Chinese) working together as a group. Present the information in the form of a booklet.
- Identify the effects of the development of empires in ancient times (e.g. more complex institutions of government resulted, empire as dominant form of political organization, increased social stratification).

Introduction

Iran, formerly known as Persia, is situated at the crossroads of Central Asia, South Asia and the Arab states of the Middle East. This strategic position—and its access to the Persian Gulf in the south—have made Iran an important country throughout its history. Much of Iran is cut off from the outside world by a beautiful and lonely landscape. High and rugged mountains create a barrier with Iran's neighbors in the west, and the eastern region is covered by a barren salty desert. In Iran's north, a narrow fertile strip borders the Caspian Sea. In the south, lowlands rim the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman. Most people in Iran live along the edges of a high plateau that runs through the middle of the country.



Map of Persian Empire (550-486 BC) Source: www.google.com

The Rise of the Persian Empire

In the 6th century BCE, the Persian people of the Ansan tribal kingdom lived under the rule of **Astyages**, of the city and tribal kingdom of Media. Ansan and the other Persian tribes were forced to pay tributes to Media, which they weren't too happy about. The Assyrians employed military force to control a vast empire. In contrast, the Persians based their empire on tolerance and diplomacy. Ancient Persia included what today is Iran.

The Persian Homeland

Indo-Europeans first migrated from Central Europe and Southern Russia to the mountains and plateaus, East of the Fertile Crescent around 1000 B.C. This area extended from the Caspian Sea in the North to the Persian Gulf in the South. In addition to fertile farmland, ancient Iran boasted a wealth of minerals. These included copper, lead, gold, silver and other precious stones. A flourishing trade in these minerals put the settlers in contact with their neighbours to the East and the West at first, dozens of tiny kingdoms occupied the region. Eventually, two major powers emerged: the Medes and the Persians.

Cyrus and the Founding of an Empire

The rest of the world paid little attention to the Persians until 550 B.C. In that year, **Cyrus**, Persia's king, began to conquer several neighboring kingdoms. Cyrus was a military genius, leading his army from victory to victory between 550 and 539 B.C. In time, Cyrus controlled an empire that covered 2,000 miles from the Indus River in the East to Anatolia in the West. Even more than his military genius, Cyrus had extraordinary administrative skills of governance. His kindness toward conquered people revealed a wise and tolerant view of empire. Unlike other conquerors, Cyrus believed in honoring local customs and religions. Instead of destroying the local temple, Cyrus knelt there to pray. Cyrus also allowed the Jews who were driven from their homeland by the Babylonians, to return to Jerusalem in 538 B.C. Under Persian rule, the Jews rebuilt their city and temple. His tolerance for others led him to develop the Charter of Human Rights. Additionally, he did not excuse slavery within his empire. Cyrus was killed as he fought nomadic invaders on the Eastern border of his Empire.



King Cyrus

Darius

Cyrus's successor, Darius, inherited a large empire. Darius, a noble of the ruling dynasty, had begun his career as a member of the king's bodyguard. An elite group of Persian soldiers, the Ten Thousand Immortals, helped Darius to seize the throne around 522 B.C. Darius spent the first three years of his reign in putting down revolts. He spent the next few years in establishing a well-organized and efficient administration. Having brought peace and stability to the empire, Darius turned his attention to conquest. He led his armies Eastward into the mountains of present-day Afghanistan and then down into the river valleys of India. The immense Persian Empire now extended over 2,500 miles, embracing Egypt and Anatolia in the West, part of India in the East, and the Fertile Crescent in the center. Darius's only failure was his inability to conquer Greece.



Sculpted figure bring gifts to Darius. The relief sculpture located in the ancient Persian capital of Persepolis, dates from around the sixth century BC.

Provinces and Satraps

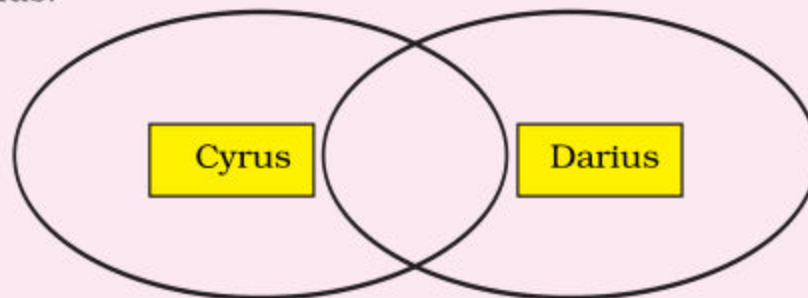
Although, Darius was a great warrior, though his real genius was in administration. To govern his extensive empire, Darius divided it into 20 provinces. These provinces were roughly similar to the homelands of the different groups of people who lived within the Persian Empire. Under Persian rule, the people of each province still practiced their own religion. They also spoke their own language and followed many of their own laws. This administrative policy of nationalities living by their own laws within one empire was repeatedly practiced in Southwest Asia. Because of tolerance of the many groups within his empire, Darius ruled with absolute power. In each province, Darius installed a governor called a satrap, who ruled locally. Darius also appointed a military leader and a tax collector for each province. To ensure the loyalty of these officials, Darius sent out inspectors known as the "King's Eyes and Ears."

Two other tools helped Darius to hold together his empire. An excellent system of roads allowed Darius to communicate quickly with the most distant parts of the empire. The famous Royal Road for example, ran from Susa in Persia to Sardis in Anatolia, which covered a distance of 1,677 miles. Darius borrowed the second tool i.e. manufacturing metal coins from the Lydians of Asia Minor. For the first time, coins of a standard value circulated throughout an extended empire. People no longer had to weigh and measure odd pieces of gold or silver to pay for what they bought. The network of roads and the wide use of standardized coins promoted trade. In turn, trade helped to hold together the empire.

Activity

Comparing and Contrasting:

Use following diagram to identify the similarities and differences between Cyrus and Darius.



Activity

On the map given below:

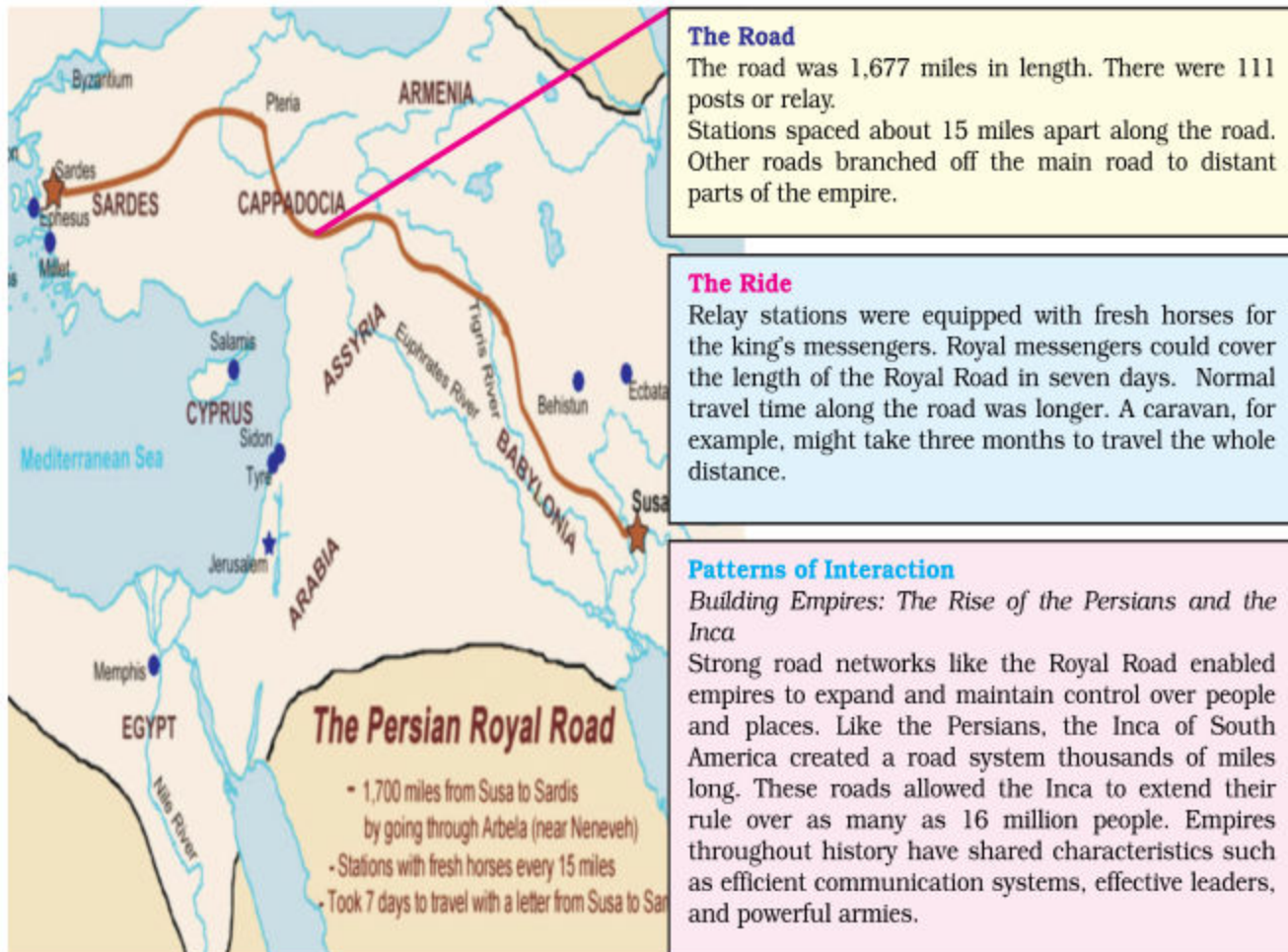
- Show the Persian Empire at the time of King Darius the Great (522-485 BCE).
- Identify the territories that were part of the Persian Empire in 500 CE.
- Illustrate on a map the expansion of the Persian Empire.



Map of the Persian Empire Source: www.google.com.pk

The Royal Road

One of the ways in which societies build and maintain empires is by establishing system of communication and transportation. The Royal Road built by the rulers of the Persian Empire connected Susa in Persia to Sardis in Anatolia.



Map of the Persian Royal Road Source: www.google.com.pk

Activity

- How would the Royal Road enable a ruler to maintain power in the empire?
- What system of communication and transportation of today might be compared to the Royal Road of the Persians?

The Persian Legacy

By the time of Darius's rule, about 2,500 years had passed since the first Sumerian city-state was built. During those years, people of the Fertile Crescent suffered war, conquest and famine. These events gave rise to a basic question: Why should so much suffering and chaos exist in the world? A Persian prophet named Zoroaster, who lived around 600 B C, offered an answer.

Zoroaster's Teachings

Zoroaster taught that the earth is a battleground where a great struggle is fought between the spirit of good and the spirit of evil. Zoroaster preached that each person is expected to take part in this struggle. The Zoroastrian religion teaches a belief in one god, Ahura Mazda. At the end of time, Ahura Mazda will judge everyone according to how well he or she fought the battle for good.

After the Muslim conquest of Persia in the A.D 600s, the Zoroastrian religion declined. Some groups carried the faith Eastward to India. Today, modern Zoroastrians continue to observe the traditions of religion in several countries including Iran and India, where its followers are called Parsis.

Political Order

Through their tolerance and good government, the Persians brought political order to Southwest Asia. They preserved ideas from earlier civilizations and found new ways to live and rule. Their respect for other cultures helped to preserve those cultures for the future. The powerful dynasty established by Cyrus in Persia lasted for 200 years and grew into a huge empire.

Decline and fall (464-330 B.C.E)

- After the death of Xerxes (486-464 B.C.E.), the Persian Empire lacked that strong hand. As a result, various problems developed that fed back upon one another and led to Persia's decline and fall. For one thing, weak rulers led to numerous provincial revolts especially in Egypt, which always had detested Persian rule.
- Secondly, the provincial satraps also became more independent. They ruled their satrapies more as kings than as the king's loyal subjects. They even carried on their own foreign policies and waged war with each other, which only added to Persia's problems.

- Revolts and unruly satraps caused serious economic problems for the empire. Persian taxes became heavier and more oppressive, which led to economic depression and revolts.
- The Persian kings also started hoarding gold and silver rather than re-circulating it. This created economic turmoil without enough gold and silver for doing business. As a result of this economic turmoil, the Persian kings got weaker, which led into the problem of revolts and powerful satraps and so on.
- Around 400 B C E , Cyrus the Younger, a royal prince, rebelled against his brother and king Artaxerxes. Although Cyrus was killed in battle, his force consisted of 10,000 Greek mercenaries survived only to find themselves stranded in the heart of Persia. This exploit known as the "March of the Ten Thousand," exposed the weakness of the Persian Empire.
- The invasion of Alexander the Great in a remarkably short time and with a small army concluded the fall of the Persian Empire.

Hence, it can be concluded that Cyrus II, often called Cyrus the Great, started the Persian Empire. His son (Cambyses II) and Cambyses' replacement (Darius the Great) pushed the borders of the empire into Egypt, India and Turkey. After death of Darius in 486 BCE, the empire began to fall into decline. Darius' son and successor, Xerxes, had the non-enviable task of quelling the many rebellions that broke out across the empire upon Darius' death and a brief succession crisis that followed. To rebuild the reputation of the empire, Xerxes first captured several Greek colonies in Asia Minor, then invaded the Greek Peloponnesian Islands. His invasion had the undesired effect of unifying the quarreling Greek city-states into a single and powerful military. As a result, the Persian navy was nearly destroyed.

SUMMARY

In this chapter, you studied about the rise of the Persian Empire, the leadership of Cyrus and Darius, the administrative, political and economic strategies of the Persian Empire that made them significant in the world, the importance of the Royal Road, the legacy of the Persian Empire, the rise of Zoroastrianism as a religion in Persia and the decline of the Persian Empire.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

Fill in the blanks

- i. The Persian Empire was founded in the year _____.
- ii. The famous road made by Darius is known as _____.
- iii. The religion that gave the answers of the questions which people have for their problems was _____.
- iv. Ansan tribal kingdom lived under the rule of another Iranian ruler named _____.

Answer the following questions

- I. Search on the internet or encyclopedia and list the battles fought between the Persians and the Greeks from 490 to 479 BCE and identify who won the battles.
- II. How did Cyrus treat the people he conquered?
- III. What methods and tools did Darius use to hold together his empire?

Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

- Search in the library, newspaper, encyclopedia, atlas or internet and find out information that describes the following aspects of the Persian Empire. Prepare a 3-D poster and present it to your school library or reading corner.
 - Influence of the Persian Empire on social, political, cultural and religious life of the people.
 - How the Persian Empire fared after the death of Alexander the Great.
 - How the Parsian Empire was affected by the Greek civilization.

Cooperate With Others

- Working together in groups of four to six students, inquire about another civilization (eg. Egyptian, Roman, Greek, Chinese). Present the information in the form of a booklet.

Teachers' Note

Encourage students to explore the recent Iran through newspaper, TV, internet or through friends who have visited. Let them share its policies, practices and culture with each other. Ask them to compare the current Iran with the Persian civilization.

SLOs:

- Identify the consequences of the fall of the Western Roman Empire. (E.g. the Dark Ages, expansion of Arab Islamic Culture).
- Define evolution of feudalism.
- Define features of feudalism.
- Describe how the responsibilities of the nobility differed from those of clergy and the peasantry during middle ages.
- Describe and locate on a map the Arab conquests in the Middle East, North Africa, Europe and India and southern Europe in the Seventh and eighth centuries.
- Identify Islamic achievements from the 7th to 15th centuries (eg. Arabic numbers).
- Describe the contributions of Ibn Sina (Avicenna) to medicine, philosophy, astronomy and mathematics.
- Describe the contribution of Muslim artists, architects and builders.
- Describe how the Islamic achievements influenced other societies. (E.g. artistic, literacy, intellectual, scientific, religious).
- Give the meaning of the word "Crusades".
- Identify the motivations for the Crusades.
- On a timeline show the battles fought during the crusades.
- Describe the effects of the Crusades.
- Inquire to identify two major events in Europe, Africa, Asia and the Americas between the fifth to fifteenth centuries.
- Give examples of major achievements in the field of art, architecture, literature, and science between the fifth to fifteenth centuries.
- Locate on a map and describe the nature of the Ottoman Empire and its expansion into the Middle East, North Africa, India and Europe from the fourteenth to sixteenth Centuries.

Introduction

In this chapter, it has been argued that the decline of European civilization paved the way for Muslim civilization. In this chapter, the expansion of Islamic civilization is discussed in detail.

The Medieval Ages

The Medieval Ages refers to a time in European history from 400-1500 AD. It occurred between the fall of the Roman Empire and the Renaissance. Historians usually divide the Medieval Ages into three smaller periods called the Early Medieval Ages, the High Medieval Ages and the Late Medieval Ages. During the medieval time, people in Europe were fighting against the Islamic Empire to take back the Eastern

Mediterranean (especially Jerusalem) for the Christian religion. These wars were called the Crusades.

The medieval age was defined by a Feudal system in Europe. This system consisted of kings, lords, knights, vassals and peasants. The people who were part of the church played an important part also. The Feudal system was the law of the land and the way that the landlords maintained control over the farmers and peasants. The landlords provided protection to the farmers. In exchange, peasants worked for them. The kings and lords lived in castles and were attended to by their personal servants called vassals. The soldiers that fought for the king and lords were called knights. When conflict arose, the peasants left their fields and villages and came into the safety of the castle walls. The church had a great influence over the people. The peasants believed that the harder they worked, the more of their money they gave to the church, and the more they served the church. By the early 1300s, Europe suffered from both war and disease. The wars were made much worse by the "Black Death", a bubonic plague. It spread along the Silk Road from China to Europe, killing millions of people caused the collapse of the Mongol Empire. By the 1400s, after the plague, Europe looked very different. The wars were over and medieval period came to an end.



Art and Literature



Social Classes

Activity

1. Find book in your library on "World History" or encyclopedia or search on internet and identify the consequences of the fall of the Western Roman Empire. (E.g. the Dark Ages, expansion of Arab Islamic Culture).
2. Define evolution of feudalism, features of feudalism and how the responsibilities of the nobility differed from those of clergy and the peasantry during middle ages.
3. Once you have found the required information, prepare a soft board presentation and share with your school.

The Rise of Islamic Culture in Western Europe

Islam began to spread in Arabia by Prophet Muhammad (Peace be Upon Him) and was later forwarded to all the corners of the world by the four pious caliphs and other religious leaders. The spread of Islam in Western Europe was done during the time of caliphs. Gradually, there became an Islamic World in Western Europe and Asia. Islamic world was not a single state in the Medieval Ages, but the different countries which formed it, had many things in common:

- It was united – the Umma was the community of all Muslim believers and shared a commitment to Islam.
- Religion and government was much more closely connected in the Muslim states than in feudal Europe. The Ulema, the experts in Sharia law were important religious scholars who advised the caliph, the leader of the Umma. Until the 9th century, the caliph was the religious and political leader of all Muslims. Later on, military leaders known as Amirs or sultans dominated the caliphs, but the caliphs kept their spiritual role.

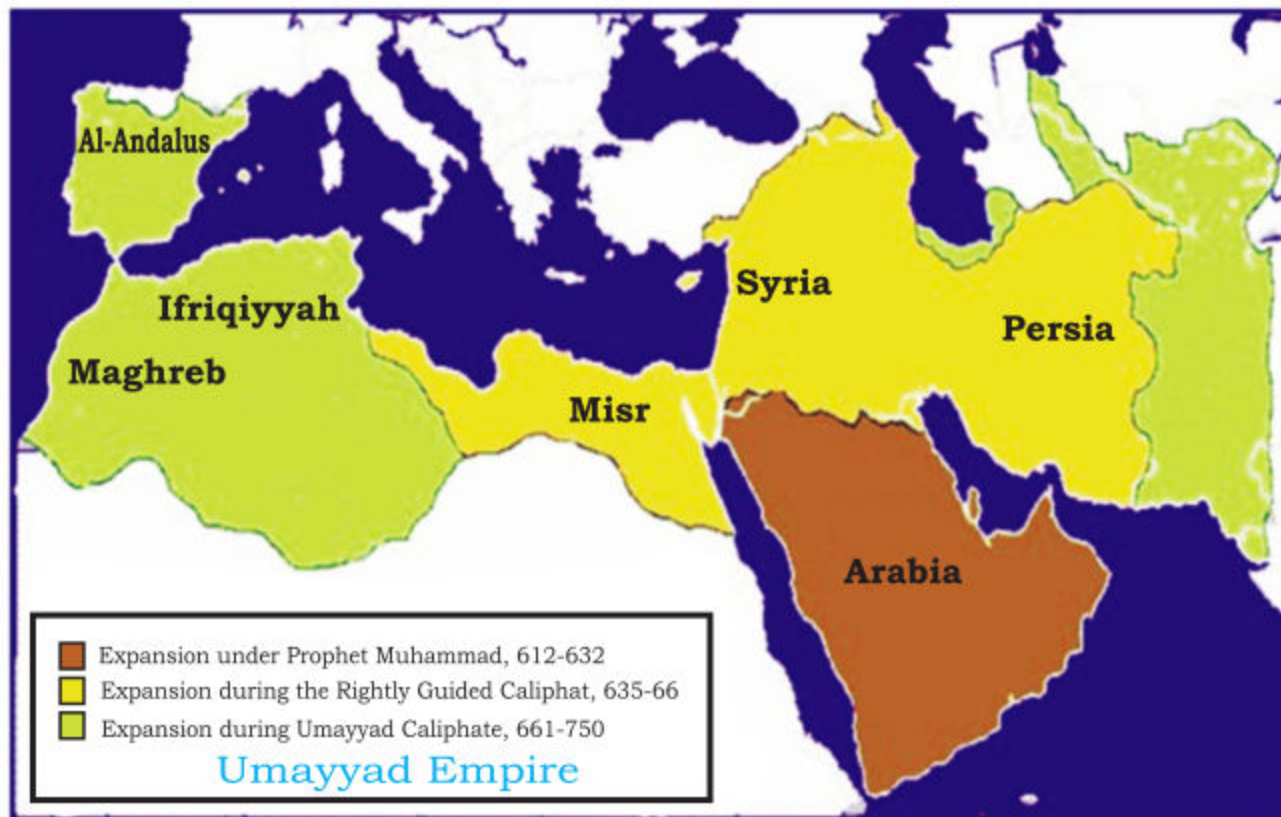
The Islamic world - a larger and more advanced Civilisation

It was created by the Arab conquests of the 7th and 8th centuries. From the 11th to the 16th centuries, thousands of Turks and Mongols migrated across the vast plains of Central Asia into the Middle East. They also adopted Islam. It spread from India to Spain. Muslim traders travelled to places such as the Sahara, South Africa, China, Scandinavia and Russia. Muslims traded high-quality goods such as silk, carpets, ivory and spices. Knowledge of science and medicine in the Islamic world was far more sophisticated than in Western Europe. Cordoba in Muslim Spain was a city of over half a million inhabitants with the facilities of street lighting and running water.

The Umayyad Succession

Hazrat Amir Muawiyah (RA) became the caliph of the Islamic world. From 661 until 750AD, Islam was spread by the descendants of Muawiyah known as Umayyads. Under the guidance of the Umayyads',

expansion of Muslim Empire started throughout the world. The Umayyad armies went to East for expansion in China as well as in Spain. Islam quickly became one of the largest and most powerful religion on the Earth. Nevertheless, the Muslims faced the bitter opposition from various religious groups.



Map of the Umayyad Dynasty

Source: www.google.com.pk

The Abbasids and Islamic Civilisation

There were religious groups that worked against the Sunni Umayyad leaders. The opposition of Ummayyads was further increased due to their attitude towards non-Arab Muslims. These non-Arabs were considered second class citizens and paid higher taxes and had fewer rights. In 747 A.D, the religious groups and non-Arab Muslims gathered together and found an army under the leadership of Abu-al-Abbas. After defeating the Umayyads, Abbas established himself as a caliph. He and his descendants ruled until 1258 A.D. They became known as the Abbasids Dynasty. Abbas built a new city and the second leader of Abbasid dynasty laid the foundation of Baghdad which grew to become one of the wealthiest cities of the region. By 900 A.D, over one million people lived and worked in Baghdad.



Map of the Abbasid Dynasty

Source: www.google.com.pk

Activity

By using the world map, identify and locate the Arab conquests in the Middle East, North Africa, Europe and India and Southern Europe during the Seventh and Eighth Centuries.

The Ottoman Empire and its Expansion

Islam was founded by the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H). At the time of His death in 632 A.D, Islam became the religion of majority of people in Arabia. By 732 A.D, the Islamic empire expanded its territories from the borders of India, through Persia and the Middle East, along the North coast of Africa, and Spain. In the 11th century, the Seljuk Turks advanced further. They defeated the Byzantine army in the Battle of Manzikert (1071 A.D) and gradually conquered Asia Minor, which is

modern-day Turkey. In the 14th century, a Turkish chieftain, Osman (1326 A.D) founded the Ottoman Turkish Empire. In the 1350s, the Turks invaded Europe. They won the Battle of Kosovo (1389 A.D) and gradually conquered the Balkans up to the borders of Hungary. In 1453 A.D, they captured Constantinople, the capital of the Byzantine Empire. The Ottoman Empire expanded as rapidly as the Turks believed in a prophecy called Osman's dream, which grew until it covered the whole world. This gave them confidence that they would win a world- wide empire. The Ottoman armies had two sections:

- Ghazis – skilled horsemen, lightly armed, fearless and brave.
- Janissaries – slaves from conquered countries, loyal, disciplined and well-trained.

Do You Know?

The killing of thousands of people by plague disease is known as the event of Black Death in history.

The Ottoman Empire had huge resources. It attacked smaller states which had been weakened by the Black Death (1347-1348 A.D).The Ottoman Empire lasted till the beginning of the First World War.



The Map of the Ottoman Empire

Source: www.google.com.pk

The Government of the Ottoman Empire



The Government of the Ottoman Empire

Key government roles in the Ottoman Empire included:

- The sultan - head of the government, with a court and a council of ministers called 'Divan'. The Ottoman sultan had absolute power. Unlike the English king, the Ottoman sultan had absolute power. All laws and decisions were made by him.
- The sultan also claimed to be a caliph and successor to the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H). By virtue of being a successor to Prophet, he declared himself a religious leader of all Muslim community.
- An efficient civil service ran the administration headed by the chief minister called the Grand Vizier, along with other ministers and scribes.
- The Ulema were the religious scholars who were experts in the Sharia law. Religion played an important role in the Ottoman government – the lawyers were religious teachers who taught Shariah Law.
- The non-Muslim communities in the Ottoman Empire were called 'millets'. They enjoyed freedom to express and to profess religion. There was a religious tolerance in the ottoman Empire.

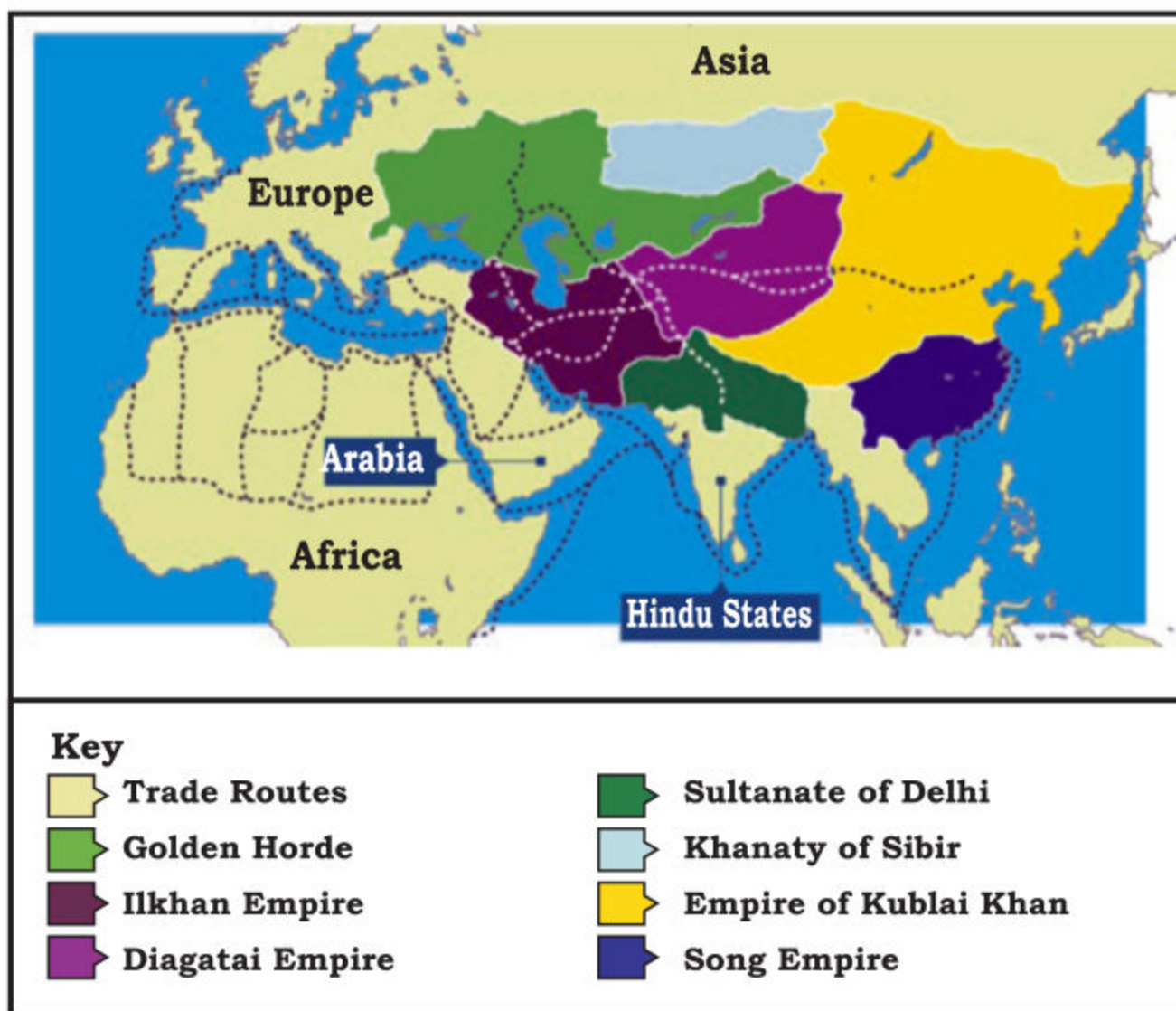
Conflicts in the Islamic World

1. The Crusades (wars between Muslims and Christians) were important wars in the history of the Islamic world.
2. The fall of Constantinople led to an influx of refugees into the rest of Europe.
3. After 1040 A.D, Seljuk Turks from Central Asia invaded and conquered the Eastern parts of the Islamic world.
4. After 1065 A.D, groups of nomadic Turks began to invade and settle in the Byzantine Empire in search of better grazing lands for their animals.
5. From the 1220s onwards, Pagan Mongols from Central Asia invaded and conquered the Eastern Islamic world. They destroyed agriculture, urban centers and slaughtered many inhabitants.
6. After 1350 A.D, the Ottoman Turks invaded Europe and conquered the Balkans. In 1453 A.D, they captured Constantinople, the capital of the Byzantine Empire.
7. By the end of the 11th Century, Spanish Christians gradually reconquered Spain and captured Granada, Which was the last Muslim state on Spanish soil in 1492 A.D.

Movement and Settlement in the Islamic World

The Islamic world experienced huge migrations of people:

- The Seljuk invasions from Central Asia in the 11th and 12th Centuries.
- The Mongol invasions from Central Asia in the 13th Century.
- Medieval Muslim traders and warriors settled over a vast area of the globe and took their religion with them.
- Muslim Arab traders and warriors set up trading posts and settlements throughout the Sahara, down the East coast of Africa, into India and even in South-East Asia.
- After the conversion to Islam, Mongols established a number of Muslim states in Iran, Central Asia and Russia. The Mongol state in Russia was called the Golden Horde.
- The Ghazi military commanders who conquered Eastern Europe after 1350 A.D were given land there as a reward.



Map of Migrations during the Ottoman Empire

Source: www.google.com

Economy and trade in the Islamic world

The Muslim economy much improved and became sophisticated than the economy of Western Europe:

- Muslim traders travelled as far as South Africa, China and Russia.
- They traded in fine quality goods like such as cotton, carpets, paper, ivory and spices.
- Hoards of medieval Muslim coins with Arabic writing on them have been discovered by archaeologists in Sweden.



Economy and Trade during the Ottoman Empire

Science, medicine and everyday life in the Islamic world

The Islamic world was much advanced than the Western world in the Medieval Ages.

Activity

Make a poster presentation on the contribution of Muslim scientists in the art, science and literature in the world. Paste on your school soft board.



Muslim Scientists

Science

- Muslim scholars were able to benefit from the books largely written by Greek, Persian, Roman, Indian and Chinese writers.
- **Al-Mamun** established a centre for translating the books from all these countries into Arabic. Later on, in 11th Century in Toledo Spain, these Arabic versions were again translated into Latin in order to circulate in all over the Christian Europe.
- **Al-Khwarazmi** discovered the number zero. The numbers (1, 2, 3, 4) used in the Arab world were much easier to use as compared to Roman numerals (I, II, III, IV).
- **Ibrahim Al-Fazari** invented a device known as the astrolabe for navigation.
- The Muslims knew a lot about astronomy. Over a hundred stars in the sky have Arabic names.

Ibn Sina (Avicenna)

- He was the most famous physician, philosopher, mathematician and astronomer of his time. His major contribution to medical science was his famous book Qanun fi-al-Tibb. His philosophical contribution is Kitab al-Shifa.
- Ibn Sina also contributed to Mathematics, Physics, Music and other fields.
- Muslim towns had hospitals with isolation units for contagious illnesses.
- Muslim doctors did post-mortems and human dissection. They noticed 400 years before the West that blood circulated round the body.
- Doctors had to pass an examination.
- Muslim surgeons anesthetized patients with cannabis and opium, used mercury and alcohol as antiseptics, and had rules about hygiene.
- There were female doctors and nurses.
- Wounded crusaders preferred to go to a Muslim doctor than a Christian one because they were more knowledgeable.

Islamic Influence on Western Europe

The Islamic empire had a huge impact on the development of medieval Western Europe. It is possible to argue that the Islamic world provided the foundations for following developments in Western Civilisation:

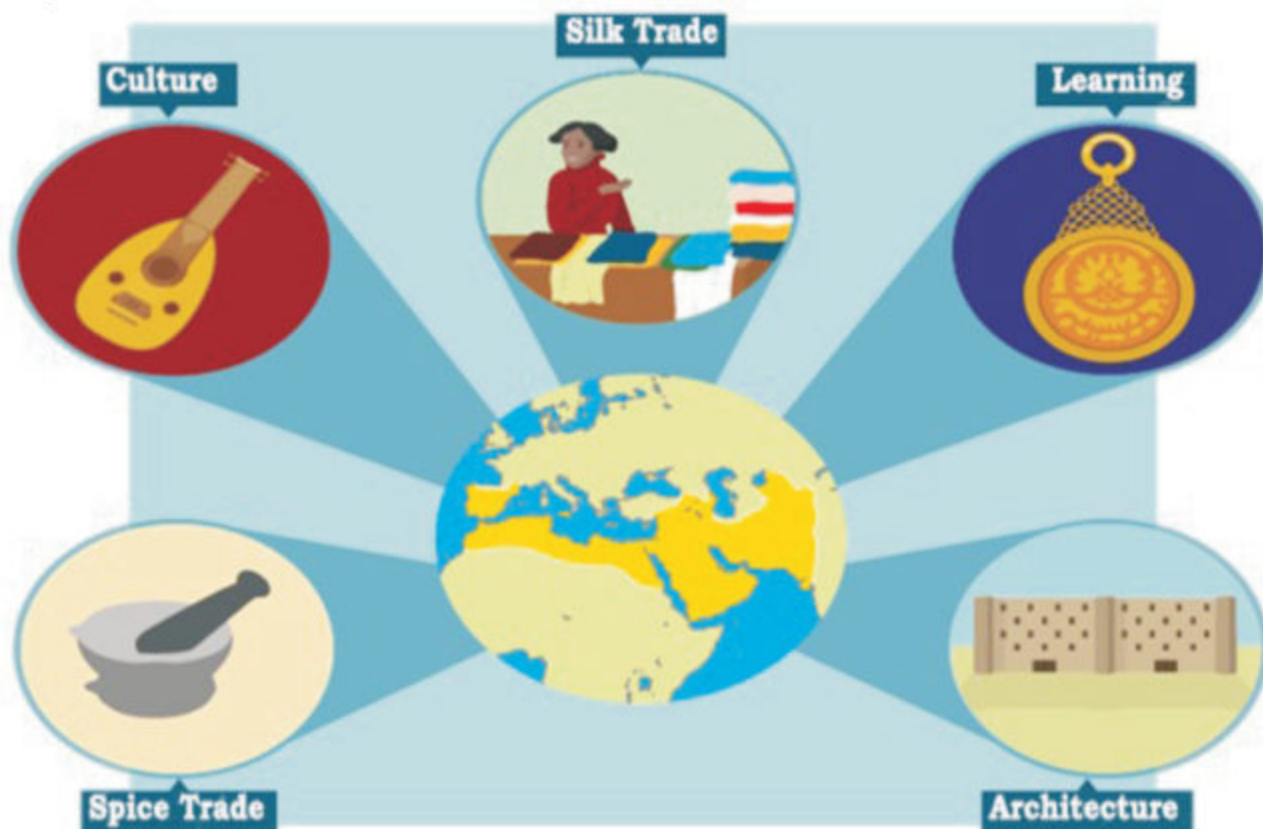
Knowledge: Western Europeans incorporated Muslim ideas on mathematics, science, medicine and astronomy into their own thinking and practices.

Medicine: The first hospital in Paris was founded by Louis IX after he came back from Crusade in 1260 A.D.

Culture: Many Western musical instruments were copied from Muslim instruments including the lute, the guitar and the violin

Trade: European noblemen bought goods that Muslim's traded in silk, spices and other things as the height of fashion. Western sailors adopted devices that had been refined by Arabs, e. g the astrolabe, which aided navigation and the triangular sail, which increased ship movements. Without these instruments, Columbus would never have reached America.

Architecture: The pointed arch from Muslim mosques was copied in western Gothic architecture. Western castle designers adopted the idea of concentric castles with layers of walls from Muslim castles which they had seen on Crusade.



Major trading items during the Ottoman Empire

It can be said there have been many reasons that brought the Medieval Ages to its decline. Many modern historians avoided using specific events and dates to mark the end of the Medieval Ages due to major differences that existed between different parts of Europe in the 15th century. In fact, the transition from the medieval era to the early modern period took place gradually and different parts of Europe went through the transitions at different paces. That could be a reason for avoiding the use of end date for middle ages.

SUMMARY

In this chapter, you studied about the Medieval Ages, causes of the fall of the Roman Empire, the expansion of Islam in Western Europe. You have also studied about the Umayyad's and Abbasids' contribution in the expansion of Islam. The contribution of Muslims scientists in the field of architecture, science and arts have been highlighted in the different sections of chapter.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

Check Your Knowledge And Understanding

Fill in the blanks

- i. The Middle Ages dates from _____ to _____.
- ii. Dark Age is referred to _____.
- iii. Crusades mean _____.
- iv. Feudal system refers to _____.
- v. Plague is a disease that brought _____ to Europe.

Answer the following Questions

Search on the internet or encyclopedia and answer the following questions:

- I. List the battles fought between the Muslims and Christians under the title of Crusades.
- II. How did the Umayyad rulers spread Islam?
- III. What were the factors due to which the Abbasid dynasty came to an end?
- IV. What factors made the Ottoman Empire flourish and spread over half of Europe?

Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

- Search in the library or on internet and find out information on the two major events in Europe and Africa, Asia and America between the fifth to fifteenth centuries. Prepare a flip chart and present it to your school library or reading corner.

Cooperate With Others

- Working together in groups of four to six students, inquire about achievements in art, architecture, literature and science in countries in Europe, Africa, Asia and the Americas between the fifth to fifteenth centuries. Share information with members of your group and discuss about the factors of decline in Muslim Science and Arts.
- Working together in groups of four to six students, inquire about at least two more empires other than Persia in the world that flourished during the same time and prepare 3-D models. Arrange a gallery walk in your school and share the political, social, administrative, economic

and military aspects of the selected empires with the students. Later, organize a mini talk and highlight the similarities and differences you found among them.

Extended Activities:

1. Construct a timeline from the ancient to the modern world highlighting the main events on it. You may use the information from chapter one to three and show the transition from BCE to CE.
2. Argue on how you think the Royal Road helped Darius to maintain control over his people.
3. Give reasons as to why you think the Persian Empire collapsed due to unskilled rulers. Can you think of any other dynasty or civilisation where the rule collapsed mainly due to their leaders?
4. Why do you think Zoroastrianism emerged as a religion in Persia? What does it really teach?
5. On a timeline, show the battles fought during the crusades.
6. Locate on a map and describe the nature of the Ottoman Empire and its expansion into the Middle East, North Africa, India and Europe from the fourteenth to sixteenth Centuries.
7. Imagine you were one of the victims of crusades, what you will do to resolve the conflicts between the two opponents.
8. Search in the library or on internet and find out information on the factors and reasons that led to the decline of the Muslims in the fifteenth century. Prepare a pictorial postcard of the factors you have inquired and share with your friends.

Teacher's Note

Encourage students to explore modern Turkey through TV dramas, movies, internet and story books. Let them share with each other the current Turkey. Once they have done that, let them see the difference between the old Turkey and the new one. What changes have they seen and why have they seen. Encourage classroom discussion on that. Ensure that most of the tasks and activities given in the book are done within the class time under your supervision.